Do’s and Don’t’s

Saving developers one tip at a time

featuring .NET MAUI

Use Shell or Tabbed/Flyout/Nav, NOT BOTH

> ⚠ **Warning**
>
> **TabbedPage** is incompatible with .NET MAUI Shell apps, and an exception will be thrown if you attempt to use **TabbedPage** in a Shell app.

Set MainPage once

Or YMMV

Consider instead how you can craft different configurations within AppShell.

Don’t nest tabs

Instead evaluate the UX and consider a different, standard approach

Reference MauiImages as PNG

The svg is only a source file that generates PNGs at the target densities and sizes.

If you need SVG, use SkiaSharp or a library like Vapolia.Svg

Don’t nest unconstrained scrolling things inside a stack layout.

A VerticalStackLayout with an unsized vertical scrollable control will not scroll or virtualize unless the height is constrained.

If the layout/scroll directions are not aligned, then it’ll work (vertical layout with a horizontal scrolling child).

Customize handlers in ConfigureHandlers()

Append/Modify etc. only run once and should be in place before the first handlers are created.

ConfigureHandlers is a builder method in MauiProgram.cs.

Don’t nest elements with gesture recognizers

A control with gesture recognizers inside of a layout with gesture recognizers is a recipe for problems.

Similarly, beware z-index issues when implementing gestures.

Move simple renderers to handler modifications.

While a renderer can be wired up in .NET MAUI, handlers are preferred.

Much simpler to implement and maintain long term.

Rewrite custom controls as handlers with mappers

Wiring up a renderer is a quick start during migration, but you may find porting the implementation to a handler faster and more reliable.

Start with wiring the handler, but don’t spend too long on it if it doesn’t work.

Prefer Grid with explicit size and * in DataTemplates

Use of Auto, and use of stack layouts inside DataTemplates are less reliable for measure/layout.

Ask Ben Buttigieg for more info ;)

Use MauiSplashScreen and Mauilcon for the simple

Use native implementations for anything more complex

Use ProjectReference, not NuGets for your libraries

Safer, easier, more things supported.

MADDY'S TURN

Random things that bite people

- You can't build MacCatalyst apps in VS Code from code saved to your Documents folder???
- You can't have a space in your project path on Mac when targeting Mac or iOS in VS Code right now WE ARE FIXING THIS! SORRY!
- Sometimes Xcode doesn’t populate the path right? It's very weird? So open **Xcode > Preferences** and check that there is actually a path for your Xcode.app